

select 'Track changes while editing'. Now any change made to the document will show up as revision marks. Changes made by different users will be marked in different colours and under the name of the machine they make the changes from.

You can even jot down comments on a particular line or portion of the text without actually changing the text. Click on **Insert > Comment** and type your observations. When you are done, the portion of text will remain highlighted and your comment will show up as a little note when the mouse is pointed to the highlighted area. To delete a note made by another user, simply right-click on the comment and choose Delete Comment.

Once all the changes have been done, you can review the final copy and accept or reject the changes (**Tools > Track Changes > Accept or Reject Changes**).

In case you sent separate copies to the people who need to work on a document, you can merge all their changes into one document rather than going through each one separately. Open the original document and in the Tools menu, click Merge Documents. Now open the reviewed copies one by one to merge them.

Thus, multiple users can make changes to the same document, while the final control over what changes get implemented still rests with you. Even if you forgot to enable change tracking, you can still view what changes have been made and accept or reject them. Simply open the edited version of the document and then, under **Tools > Track Changes**, select Compare Documents.

Versioning: You can save on disk space and clutter by saving multiple versions of a document in one file. Here Word automatically saves a 'snapshot' of just the changes when you close a file, with a record of the date, time and the name of the person making the changes.

You can manually save versions of the file by clicking on **File > Versions > Save Now**, or you can set Word to automatically save a version when you close the file. For this, click on **File > Versions** and select 'Automatically save a version on close'; click on Close.

Versioning helps you keep track of all the changes and stages the document has been through. To view an earlier version, in **File > Versions**, simply click on the

Routing a Document for Review

If you need several people to work on a Word document sequentially, so that each person gets to see the comments made by those who have reviewed it before, you can route it through e-mail. Under **File > Send To**, click Routing Recipient and click Address to select the people you want it sent to; click OK. The document will be mailed as an attachment to the first person on the list. After he or she has finished editing it, he or she simply needs to point to **File > Send To** and click Next

Routing Recipient. In this manner, the file will be mailed to people in the order in which their e-mail address has been listed; click Route document to recipient name. The document is automatically returned to you after all recipients have finished with it.

Remember that when routing a document for review, if you add a group address rather than individual addresses, it will be routed to all members of the group simultaneously.

version of the document you want to view and it will be displayed in a separate window. You can even make changes in an earlier version by saving it as a separate file. You may also want to save a multi-versioned file as a separate file so that viewers can access only the final version. Saving as a separate file also aids in comparing it with an earlier version.

Document properties: You can also track a document within the organisation through the Document Properties. This feature allows you to store additional information about a document, other than the

default properties. These include the date of completion, project, publisher, reference, source, status and other details that would aid you in tracking the document. To modify the custom file property, click on **File > Properties** and then click the Custom tab. Next, select the custom property you want to modify, select the type and enter a new value in the Value box. Click on Add to finish.

Stay in touch with NetMeeting



Meetings are an integral part of any working day, but you can confer with others right

through your desktop, thanks to the Internet and instant messengers. To send a file through MSN Messenger, all one has to do is go to **Action > Send a File or Photo...** and attach the file and click Send.

In addition, you have free utilities such as NetMeeting, an excellent office pro-

ductivity tool that lets you hold virtual meetings, and share ideas and resources across different computers and networks. You can use NetMeeting along with a Web cam to hold a video meeting, or just chat with the people at the other end. The whiteboarding function makes it very easy to share ideas across the network. One remarkable feature in NetMeeting is the ability to share and control programs. This



The Whiteboard function in NetMeeting opens a separate window where the online meeting participants can type text, draw shapes, copy, paste and delete objects, and highlight or point to text and graphics

way, you can securely control applications and even the desktop of a remote computer. NetMeeting also lets you securely transfer files to the recipients. Obviously, both parties must have NetMeeting started.

Start NetMeeting, go to **Call > New Call** and enter the IP address of the person you

want to hold a meeting with. Next, from Using, select Automatic, which will set the default values, so connecting will be hassle-free. Click Call. In case your meeting revolves around a particular report or document, use the Share Program icon—to do this, open the document on your

TIP Since the tracked changes can be quite distracting as you read the document on screen, you can turn off the option of viewing the changes on screen. Click on **Tools > Track Changes > Highlight changes**. Select 'Track changes while editing', but unselect 'highlight changes on screen'.

TIP NetMeeting is tightly integrated into MSN Messenger too, so if you have NetMeeting installed, you can start it from MSN from **Actions > Start NetMeeting**—this allows you to directly switch from the IM to NetMeeting.